

SANTIAGO SALAS

Senior Frontend Engineer

Frontend architecture · Product engineering · Applied AI

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Senior frontend engineer with **7 years of experience** solving product and engineering challenges across enterprise SaaS, scientific data, computer vision, and digital products for international clients. I have owned the technical definition, delivery, and evolution of complex interfaces and workflows in legacy environments with multiple teams and demanding quality standards. As a co-founder, I took a ticketing platform from initial validation to use at live events and brought AI capabilities into product experiences. I combine UX, business judgment, and frontend architecture to turn ambiguous needs into solutions that reach production.

CORE SKILLS

Frontend: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Angular, Redux Toolkit, TanStack React Query, HTML Canvas, REST and GraphQL APIs, Material UI, Tailwind CSS, Vite, Storybook, design systems, performance, and testing (Jest, Vitest, React Testing Library). **Architecture and delivery:** modular applications, integration with existing systems, Git, Docker Compose, and feature flags. **Product and AI:** solution definition, UX/UI, prioritization and MVP validation; collaboration with clients and business teams; AI workflow design, model integration in products, and agent-assisted development with Claude Code and Cursor.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Frontend Developer | Cafeto Software

May 2025 - Aug 2026

Remote · Full-time assignment to Apptega, an international client

- Developed and evolved assessment, risk, and compliance program modules for Apptega, an enterprise cybersecurity and GRC SaaS platform; managed interdependent state and improved data retrieval and presentation in information-dense interfaces.
- Defined technical solutions and implemented new workflows as the product was progressively modernized, integrating React modules with legacy Angular applications and services.
- Extended reusable components in a design system shared across applications and implemented UI and behavioral tests to support ongoing product development.
- Worked across multiple repositories in a Docker-based environment with private npm packages, feature flags, and legacy code; coordinated cross-module changes to maintain a coherent user experience.
- Refined requirements, proposed solutions, and presented progress to product, design, backend, QA, DevOps, sales, technical and executive leadership, and clients.

Technologies: React, TypeScript, Angular, TanStack React Query, Material UI, Vite, Storybook, Jest, Vitest, React Testing Library, Karate, Docker Compose, Git, Cursor, Claude Code.

Co-founder & Product Engineer | PASSTIX

Launched in 2025

Independent product · Pasto, Colombia

- Co-founded and launched a ticketing platform used at live events, taking it from problem validation and MVP to online sales and access operations with real buyers and organizers.
- Designed the user experience and developed the frontend for checkout, event management, ticket issuance, and QR-based access validation; carried interface decisions from prototype into live operations.
- Defined and prioritized features based on organizer and attendee needs, coordinating delivery with the co-founder responsible for the backend.

Technologies: React, TypeScript, Redux Toolkit, TanStack React Query, Framer Motion, Tailwind CSS, Firebase, Meta Pixel, Leaflet, Three.js, Recharts, payment gateway integration, Vitest, JSDOM, Figma, Cursor, Claude Code.

Frontend Developer | 57Blocks

May 2024 - May 2025

Remote · Projects for international clients

- Led technical planning and development from scratch for an application envisioned as a commercial product. Its AI workflows automated software project documentation, planning, and tracking based on meetings. Defined the initial frontend and backend architecture using hexagonal principles and advanced the project to an early MVP.
- Designed and integrated workflows for working with documents, generating content, and querying project information, using Dify to build and test the AI capabilities.
- Developed web modules for Presidium Residential and shaped their UI in direct contact with the client and its marketing and sales teams; also updated modules in its existing Flutter and Dart mobile app.
- Implemented interactive modules for an IndyCar Series event site, including a mini-game and components of the ticket purchase flow.

Technologies: React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Next.js, Redux, Tailwind CSS, GraphQL, WordPress, Flutter, Dart, Dify, Python, FastAPI, Cursor.

Frontend Developer | LinkedAI

Nov 2022 - Feb 2024

Remote · International SaaS

- Developed image annotation, segmentation, and review tools with HTML Canvas, designing precise editing interactions and managing complex state for dataset preparation.
- Built features to organize projects and image collections and review large data volumes, improving interface responsiveness and the clarity of review workflows.
- Integrated Segment Anything Model (SAM) into annotation workflows, bringing AI-assisted segmentation to label creation and editing.

Technologies: React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Redux, Material UI, HTML Canvas, GraphQL, REST, Jest, React Testing Library, AWS.

Frontend Developer | Colombian Geological Survey

Mar 2020 - Nov 2021

Remote · Bogotá, Colombia

- Built public seismic and volcanic activity viewers from scratch, turning large geoscience datasets into maps, charts, and clear exploration views for diverse audiences.
- Implemented search, filters, and detailed views for events and historical records, managing query state and interface performance to keep exploration responsive.
- Built a historical catalog for institutional records and documents and developed additional features for the Colombian Geological Survey portal.

Technologies: React, JavaScript, Redux, Material UI, Sass, REST APIs, Git.

EDUCATION, LANGUAGES AND RECOGNITION

Systems Engineering - Universidad Mariana (2014-2019), honorable mention. **English B2** (CEFR), APTIS 2022; experience working with international teams. **Recognition:** Distinguished Alumnus 2021 (Production, Research, Technology and Innovation); Saber Pro top score recognition, 2019; PASSTIX, a finalist in Innovapaz 2026 in Nariño, Colombia.